

CHASSEUR UNIFORM

The appearance of Napoleon's cavalry regiments changed frequently between 1799 and 1815 and the uniform of each regiment and of each company within a regiment boasted its own particular distinguishing features. The one shown here is that of the 1er Chasseurs à Cheval de la Ligne, 2e Compagnie from around the year 1806. The matching red facings on the collar and cuffs indicate the regiment, the pale blue pompom on the shako the company. As well as his basic uniform, the chasseur always carried a dark green cape *(capote)* that was stowed away under his saddle cover *(shabraque)* when not needed.



Shirt and stock
The long white cotton shirt was worn tucked into the breeches and tied between the cavalryman's legs. The collar was fastened with an unobtrusive black stock designed simply to keep the neck looking smart and tidy.

Shako
The shako was adopted by many cavalry – and infantry – regiments across Europe at the end of the 18th century. This 1806 model worn by the chasseurs was made chiefly of felt and leather, with a waterproof top. It was secured under the chin by brass chinscales.

Dolman and waistcoat
The tight-fitting braided jacket worn by chasseurs and hussars was known as a dolman (originally from a Turkish word for a much looser garment). Dark green was the traditional colour of the French chasseurs, who liked to swagger around with only the top four buttons of their dolmans done up in order to show off their splendid red waistcoats.





Crossbelts fixed together by stud on cavalryman's chest



Sabre, worn slung from a belt at the left hip



Cartridge box and bread bag carried over the shoulder